

Writing Letters

Formal letters are for people you don't know

- 1) Start with a **formal greeting**. For example, 'Dear Sir / Madam' or 'Dear Mr Jones'.
- 2) **End** with 'Yours sincerely' if you know their name or 'Yours faithfully' if you don't.
- 3) Avoid **slang** and **exclamation marks**.

Informal letters are for people you know well

- 1) Start with the reader's **name**. End with 'Best wishes' or 'See you soon'.
- 2) You can be more **chatty** but make sure your spelling and grammar are correct.

Follow the rules for writing letters

There are some things that all **formal letters** need.

EXAMPLE:

The diagram shows a formal letter with the following parts and labels:

- Name or title of the person you're writing to:** Points to 'Head of Customer Services, Independent Banking Company, 54 Field Street, Bampton, BR8 4PL'.
- Address of the person:** Points to the same address block.
- Use the person's name if you know it:** Points to 'Dear Sir / Madam,'.
- Use this if you don't know their name:** Points to 'Dear Sir / Madam,'.
- Your full name:** Points to 'Mrs Dawn G. Starling'.
- Your address:** Points to '7 Green Drive, Gressington, Kent, BR6 9TS'.
- Today's date:** Points to '17th November'.
- Use paragraphs:** Points to the body text: 'I am writing to close my savings account. My account number is 87464290. I would like to cancel the account because of your poor customer service. Your call centre staff are rude every time I call. Please let me know when you have closed the account.'
- Add a comma here if you put one after the greeting — they need to match:** Points to the comma after 'Yours faithfully,'.

The letter content is as follows:

7 Green Drive
Gressington
Kent
BR6 9TS
17th November

Head of Customer Services
Independent Banking Company
54 Field Street
Bampton
BR8 4PL

Dear Sir / Madam,

I am writing to close my savings account. My account number is 87464290.
I would like to cancel the account because of your poor customer service. Your call centre staff are rude every time I call.
Please let me know when you have closed the account.

Yours faithfully,

Mrs Dawn G. Starling

Practice Question

- 1) Write a letter applying for the job described below. Make sure your layout is correct.

Food Xpress is looking for staff to work on the tills in their new supermarket. Staff must be over 16, friendly and hard-working. If you would like to apply, please write to the Store Manager, Mr Simon Green. The address is Food Xpress, 17 Park Road, Middleton, Surrey, KT8 7MF.

You should include:

- why you would like the job
- why you're a suitable applicant